

Alternating Characters

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You are given a string containing characters *A* and *B* only. Your task is to change it into a string such that there are no matching adjacent characters. To do this, you are allowed to delete zero or more characters in the string.

Your task is to find the minimum number of required deletions.

Example

$s = AABAAB$

Remove an *A* at positions 0 and 3 to make $s = ABAB$ in 2 deletions.

Function Description

Complete the `alternatingCharacters` function in the editor below.

`alternatingCharacters` has the following parameter(s):

- string *s*: a string

Returns

- int: the minimum number of deletions required

Input Format

The first line contains an integer *q*, the number of queries.

The next *q* lines each contain a string *s* to analyze.

Constraints

- $1 \leq q \leq 10$
- $1 \leq \text{length of } s \leq 10^5$
- Each string *s* will consist only of characters *A* and *B*.

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Difficulty: [Easy](#)
Max Score: 20
Submitted By: [342378](#)

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```

1  import java.io.*;
2  import java.util.*;
3  import java.util.stream.*;
4
5  class Result {
6
7      /*
8       * Complete the 'alternatingCharacters' function below.
9       *
10      * The function is expected to return an INTEGER.
11      * The function accepts STRING s as parameter.
12      */
13
14      public static int alternatingCharacters(String s) {
15
16          int count = 0;
17
18          for (int i = 1; i < s.length(); i++) {
19
20              // If two adjacent characters are same,
21              // one character must be deleted.
22              if (s.charAt(i) == s.charAt(i - 1)) {
23                  count++;
24              }
25          }
26
27          return count;
28      }
29  }
30
31  public class Solution {
32
33      public static void main(String[] args) throws IOException {
34
35          BufferedReader bufferedReader =

```

Upload Code as File

Test against custom input

Run Code

Submit Code

Congratulations!

You have passed the sample test cases. Click the submit button to run your code against all the test cases.

Sample Test case 0

Sample Test case 1

Sample Test case 2

Input (stdin)

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```
1 5
2 AAAA
3 BBBBB
4 ABABABAB
5 BABABA
6 AAABBB
```

Your Output (stdout)

```
1 3
2 4
3 6
```